

Prema-vilasa

"The Pastimes of Love"

A poem by Nityananda Dasa

Translated from the Bengali

Translator's note

The *Prema-vilasa* is a Bengali poem by Nityananda Dasa (Balarama Dasa), a disciple of Jahnava Devi, on the lives of Srinivasa Acharya, Narottama Thakura and Shyamananda: their training in Vrindavana under

Jiva Gosvami, the bringing of the Gosvamis' books to Bengal, and their preaching in Gauda, Orissa and Vishnupura.

Source. The edition of 1913 (Calcutta, Bagbazar; public domain), collated from two independent OCR copies (the 1913 edition and its 1999 reprint). **Only the poem itself** is translated: the editors' prefaces and notes are not. Vilasas 1–23 are translated; the twenty-fourth vilasa (a late genealogical addition) and the appendix are not included.

Principles. The payar couplets are translated line by line, without rhyme, and numbered within each vilasa (the original has no numbering); tripadi stanzas, songs and Sanskrit verses are numbered as single units. Corrupt passages are noted in the translator's notes at the end of each vilasa. Names follow GLOSSARY.md.

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Vilasa 1. The Description of Srinivasa Acharya's Birth

Mahaprabhu's distress that Gauda has lost bhakti; counsel with Sarvabhauma; Jagannatha's command to grant prema to the son of the childless brahmana Chaitanya Dasa; the Earth gives prema to Lakshmipriya; Srinivasa's birth at Chakhandi

1. I did not worship your lotus feet in the Kali age,
I did not see your golden form in the Kali age,
I did not hear the tales of your truth in the Kali age —
O Chaitanya-chandra, you have left me deprived!¹
2. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
3. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
Glory, glory to the mantra of Hari-nama in the Kali age!²
4. Glory, glory to Srinivasa Acharya Thakura,
whose disciple Ramachandra is the sprout of prema!
5. Glory, glory to Kaviraja Thakura Govinda,
by whose virtues the beings of the seven islands rejoice!
6. Glory, glory to the listeners — give your attention,
you whose very life the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will become.
7. How the birth of Acharya Thakura came about —
listen, brothers, with devotion and a steady heart.
8. Mahaprabhu sent Nityananda Prabhu to Gauda,
and he flooded Gauda with prema-bhakti.
9. All the Vaishnavas who came from Gauda
Mahaprabhu questioned in every detail.
10. Some said: "In Gauda there is no Hari-nama;
there is no deliverance for good people or for bad."
11. Some said: "Acharya Gosani has left bhakti
and everywhere makes people accept mukti as the chief thing."
12. Some said: "He has no word but mukti;
speaking of mukti, Gosani has flooded the world."
13. As he listened, the Lord's anger arose,
and the grief of separation from Nityananda grew in him.
14. At this time Svarupa and Ramananda Raya came to the Lord;
they wished to speak, and there was joy in their hearts.
15. "Come in, come in, it is good that you two have come!
Gauda has become empty of bhakti — hear the reason.
16. Advaita Acharya, the very form of Ishvara,
has left bhakti and expounds the five kinds of mukti."³
17. I cannot understand Advaita's mind.
Tell me, both of you, how bhakti is to be kept.

18. I cannot believe that he teaches mukti,
for he is a chief participant in these pastimes.⁴
19. I hear it from people's mouths, but I am not convinced:
to expound mukti, leaving bhakti, is not his intent."
20. At this time a letter came from Nityananda:
"Leaving the path of bhakti, the Acharya preaches mukti."
21. On receiving the letter the Lord was greatly alarmed;
holding the letter in his own hand he went for darshan.
22. With his devotees the Lord went into the temple
and beside Garuda⁵ beheld the Lord with joy in his heart.
23. At that time Sarvabhauma Bhattacharya came;
seeing him, the Lord was overcome with ecstasy.
24. Crying "Bhakti, bhakti!" the Lord was filled with prema
and, rejecting the explanations of mukti, began to extol bhakti.
25. Embracing the Bhattacharya, he came out
and, reaching Mishra's residence,⁶ grew somewhat calmer.
26. Nityananda Prabhu's letter was in his hand.
"Read the letter, Bhattacharya," the Lord commanded.
27. Reading the letter, the Bhattacharya flew into a great rage:
"It seems no one in Gauda has any understanding!
28. Who is this who rejects bhakti and preaches mukti?
The three of us will go to that place.
29. In debate, Prabhu, I will silence him,
and if he is obstinate I will bind him and bring him here."⁷
30. At the Bhattacharya's words the Lord's heart rejoiced:
"There will be no hindrance to bhakti — listen, Mahashaya.
31. One letter under my own signature will go to Advaita,
and another he will write to Sri Nityananda Prabhu."
32. Saying "Good, good," they settled this plan firmly
and sent the letters to Gauda by the hand of Vaishnavas.
33. Hearing this, the high-minded Bhattacharya
joined his palms and told of his own former plight:
34. "Studying logic, I knew not a speck of bhakti;
now, leaving the explanations of mukti, I find a special joy in bhakti.
35. How long I spent chewing the dry oil-cake of logic!
Then I came to talk with Gopinatha Acharya.
36. He is not ill-minded nor under maya — he is the Lord's devotee;
how should he not know the truth of the Lord's own nature?
37. Through my bond with him the Lord showed me mercy:
all my wrong thinking went, and bhakti was born in my heart.
38. He is very dear to the Lord, a king among devotees;
his work is to bring the world to understanding."

39. All went off to their own places,
yet joy did not arise in the Lord's mind.
40. The more he thought, the more his anxiety grew:
"Living beings have become empty of bhakti!" — and fear arose in him.
41. "How will bhakti remain upon the earth?
I want to send some prema and the Name to Gauda.
42. While Nityananda is here, how is this to be done?
And when he is gone, how will bhakti remain among the beings?
43. To reveal the scriptures of bhakti, Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, went to Vrindavana.
44. That bhakti I want to reveal in Gauda;
I want a vessel to be born who is prema in form."
45. "Avani! Avani!"⁸ the Lord called out,
and the Earth with joined palms came before the Lord.
46. "Listen, listen, Earth, and be attentive:
bring a vessel who is prema in form and give him a dwelling."
47. "The prema that you, my Lord, have left in my keeping —
give the command, and I will make it manifest in a form."
48. Delighted, the Lord gave the Earth his command,⁹
but of who was worthy to be the vessel, and of his name, nothing was said.¹⁰
49. At this time Svarupa and Ramananda Raya came to the Lord;
bowing to the Lord, they wished to speak to him.
50. "What am I to do, what will happen? It is good that you have come" —
and he told them all that had passed with the Earth.
51. Crying "Prema, prema!" the Lord was overcome
and, calling "Nityananda!", began to weep.
52. The Lord fell senseless; the third watch¹¹ went by;
in a sweet voice Svarupa sang Hari-nama to him.
53. On hearing Hari-nama the Lord came to himself:
"Come, Svarupa, let us go and see the Lord."
54. At this time Sarvabhauma appeared before the Lord;
seeing Sarvabhauma, the Lord was very glad.
55. "It is good that you have come; sit here.
There is a special matter — listen carefully.
56. Advaita Acharya has put away the path of bhakti.
What am I to say, what am I to do — tell me, Bhattacharya."
57. Hearing of this hindrance to bhakti, the Bhatta was much grieved,
and then he spoke at Mahaprabhu's feet:
58. "Advaita Acharya is the lord of the world;
such words will never come from his mouth.
59. Some insolent people¹² came and told this to the Lord.
Bring those people before me!"

60. They searched, but those people could not be found,
and the Bhatta declared them to be great ignoramuses.¹³
61. "Listen, listen, Bhattacharya, I will tell you of the past:
ever since I left Navadvipa, he has been in great sorrow.
62. I cannot tell what is in his mind in that sorrow:
to frighten me he acts as he pleases.
63. He has the power to do anything:
what he does comes to pass and is never in vain.
64. I have faith in his word,
and I cannot go against his command.
65. Devise a plan, then, so that his command is not slighted
and that, by this plan, prema is preserved hereafter."
66. The Bhattacharya said: "Prabhu, while Nityananda is here,
while he is present, prema will meet no obstacle.
67. What will happen when he is gone — what can I say?
Do whatever is in your mind.
68. Of this, Prabhu, my own Mayavada is witness:
leaving mukti, I expound bhakti by your grace.
69. By seeing you, Prabhu, my bondage was destroyed,
and leaving mukti I became a servant on the path of bhakti.
70. The people of the Kali age are very wicked,
and the chief cause of it is the rule of the yavana kings.¹⁴
71. All that the kings' rule had brought, he did away with,
and he revealed the great medicine, the mantra of Hari-nama.
72. By the mere shadow of the Name he destroyed sins;
Nityananda, your own portion, established bhakti.
73. Such a Nityananda Prabhu you sent to Gauda —
why then do you begin to worry about the future?"
74. "All that is true; but listen with attention:
I sent Nityananda off together with the devotees,
75. I myself parted from Nityananda.
What am I to do — give me your counsel."
76. "No one can counsel you better
than One — in Nilachala there is Jagannatha Raya."
77. "The Bhatta Mahashaya has given a fine solution:
without Jagannatha this cannot be settled."
78. Having so resolved, they all went for darshan
and prayed that prema might be preserved hereafter:
79. "You are an ocean of compassion, most merciful.
We pray to you, Lord — be sure to answer.
80. In the Kali age you descended in the form of Jagannatha;
seeing you and believing, people have been delivered.

81. With the sweetness and fragrance of your prasada you flooded the land,
making the varnas and ashramas and even the chandalas one.
82. In this way let the pastimes of Radha and Krishna spread,
and in granting favour or punishment let no one weigh who is worthy."¹⁵
83. The fourteen-cubit swinging garland¹⁶ broke from the Lord's neck;
the pujari brought it and held it out before the Lord.
84. Delighted, the Lord came back to his lodging,
and his heart was filled with joy beyond measure.
85. Free from worry, he lay down to rest,
and Jagannatha came to his bedside.
86. Smiling, Jagannatha said to him:
"Is my power so very much greater than yours?"
87. For a long time now there has been a brahmana;
childless, he came to pray for a son.
88. Whenever he came for darshan he begged for the boon of a son,
always weeping, with an anguished heart.
89. Seeing the brahmana so distressed, I was moved to great compassion
and, being pleased, granted him the boon of a son.
90. His name is Chaitanya Dasa Acharya;
from him will come that most worthy vessel, the embodiment of prema.¹⁷
91. You shall entrust the prema to him,
so that the brahmana grieves no more.
92. Lakshmipriya is his wife, the daughter of Balarama¹⁸ —
virtuous, devoted to her husband, most blessed."
93. At that moment Mahaprabhu awoke,
and calling "Jagannatha!" he wept a long while.
94. Calling Kashi Mishra, the Lord asked him:
"Show me the Gaudiya Chaitanya Dasa.
95. Jagannatha has given me a command concerning him;
take pains and bring him quickly."
96. Mishra said: "Prabhu, many days have passed;
weeping, the brahmana went back to his own country."
97. The Lord said: "Do you know where his home is?"
Mishra said: "I will find it out for certain."
98. At this time Jagadananda came from Vrindavana,
and the Lord began to ask him about Sanatana's welfare.
99. He said: "All are in perfect fulfilment and bliss,"
and told the Lord how each one was.
100. "After seeing Mother's feet I came to Navadvipa,
and then I came to Shantipur, to the Acharya.
101. At my leave-taking Gosani gave me a command:
'What I say, repeat it to Him.'¹⁹

102. And he spoke a riddle."²⁰ Hearing this, Mahaprabhu said:
"Words such as he spoke I have never heard."
103. Svarupa and others were there together with Mahaprabhu;
hearing the riddle, they all began to laugh.
104. From that day the Lord's condition changed:
the malady of separation from Krishna grew twofold.
105. "What was said has come to pass"²¹ — you two have heard it.
Consider how prema may be preserved.
106. Jagannatha has commanded me to see the brahmana;
take pains to bring him — I wish to send him to his country."
107. Meanwhile the Earth could not bear the weight of prema,
and an earthquake struck all of Nilachala-puri.
108. Day and night Nilachala shook.
"This is no earthquake, brothers — it is Chaitanya doing all this!
109. Earlier Chaitanya gave prema to the ocean
and flooded Nilachala-puri with prema.
110. The ocean, it seems, could not hold that prema;
taking the prema from it, he gave it to the Earth.
111. The Earth cannot hold it and is shaking;
houses may collapse and people may die!
112. All this time we have lived in Nilachala, brothers —
and now Chaitanya-chandra has come and does such things!"
113. They all took counsel together on what should be done:
"Let us go to a land where everyone's life will be safe."
114. One says: "There is no land apart from the earth;
come what may, I shall stay right here."
115. One says: "You have no sons or children,
and besides, you are poor and own no property —
116. for fear of what would you leave Nilachala?
Either way we shall all die.
117. If Jagannatha protects us in this calamity,
then easily, brothers, we shall remain in the world."
118. One says: "Brother, what will Jagannatha do?
Chaitanya's rasa, brother, will only grow twofold!"
119. One says: "Let us all gather together,
go to Sri Krishna Chaitanya and lay it before him."
120. Saying "Good, good," they all gathered together
and arrived at Mishra's door.
121. The crowd made a great uproar at the door,
and the Lord came out with Svarupa and the others.
122. Seeing the Lord, the distressed people of Nilachala —
children, old men, young men, householders and ascetics — cried out:

123. "When the city was floating in the water, you saved it;
now the city is shaking — a calamity has come.
124. This time save us, Lord Gaurachandra!
With what mantra have you made the earth unsteady?
125. There is none but you to save us in calamity;
in fear we have come to plead with you.
126. You are the purifier of the fallen, most merciful;
do not forsake us who have taken refuge in Jagannatha."²²
127. At this time the pujari, bringing Jagannatha's prasada,
came to where the Lord was.
128. Seeing the prasada, Mahaprabhu rose,
bowed down and placed the prasada beside him.
129. The pujari said: "Prabhu, I cannot perform the service:
whenever I lay my hands on Jagannatha, my whole body spins."²³
130. What am I to do? Save us, Prabhu — the service has stopped!
In fear I have come to tell you."
131. Then the Lord called the Earth:
"For some days stay still."
132. Hearing what people were saying, the pujari was afraid:
"It is Advaita Mahashaya who has landed us in this calamity!"
133. With joined palms the pujari addressed the Lord.
"Do your service," said the Lord, and he laid his hands on Jagannatha's body.
134. Dismissing the pujari, the Lord said before the people:
"Go, go, brothers, all of you go home in peace.
135. There will be no earthquake; I will pray to Jagannatha,
and I will beg it of the Earth as alms."
136. Humbly dismissing all the people,
he began to think about the brahmana Chaitanya Dasa.
137. Thinking so, he called the Earth to mind;
the Earth came and bowed to the Lord.
138. "What is your command, Prabhu?" the Earth asked.
The Lord asked where Chaitanya Dasa lived.
139. The Earth said: "Prabhu, many bear that name;
how shall I know for certain?"
140. The Lord said: "For the sake of a son, before Jagannatha,
for a whole year he prayed with body and mind.
141. That Chaitanya Dasa you must seek out;
the father of his wife Lakshmipriya is Balarama Dasa."²⁴
142. "As you command," said the Earth and departed,
and on the third day she came and reported to the Lord:
143. "He lives at Chakhandi, very pure in conduct;
in his body there is no trace of sin.

144. For the sake of a son he began a purashcharana,²⁵
and soon he left, entrusting it to Jagannatha."
145. The Lord said: "Earth, you have been a great help:
Jagannatha has kept his word about prema firm.
146. Listen, listen, Earth, listen with care:
take the prema and give it to Lakshmipriya.
147. Give her all the prema, keep nothing back.
My word is true — you must carry it out."²⁶
148. Overjoyed, the Earth began to dance,
brought the prema and laid it before Lakshmipriya.
149. And here the Lord, free from worry, began kirtana
and started to dance in the courtyard of Jagannatha's temple.
150. Before Jagannatha, with joined palms, the Lord
wept aloud, crying "Srinivasa! Srinivasa!"
151. Seeing this, Jagannatha laughed with delight
and sent prema to Chaitanya Dasa.
152. Seeing Jagannatha laugh, the Lord laughed too,
and by his command sent prema to Chaitanya Dasa.
153. "From this a son named Srinivasa will be born,
and through him there will be a great play of prema."²⁷
154. To reveal the various scriptures I sent Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, to Sri Vrindavana.
155. In Rupa's scriptures the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will be revealed,
and by command they will be entrusted to Srinivasa."
156. Having prayed to Jagannatha, he came back to his lodging
and joyfully summoned Kashi Mishra.
157. He took secret counsel with Svarupa and Ramananda;
having received Jagannatha's command, his mind was at ease.
158. "Tell us, tell us, Prabhu, give us the news!" —
"In Chaitanya Dasa's house prema will be made known.
159. In Gauda Nityananda Raya is anxious;
send him a letter and set his mind at rest."
160. "Good, good," and the Lord wrote in his own hand:
"Hari-nama sankirtana will be in every house.
161. You shall send a letter to Advaita Acharya,
that he should count the state of mukti without bhakti as worthless.
162. Do not worry about me hereafter;
the world will float in Hari-nama sankirtana.
163. By Jagannatha's command a son will be born by a boon,
who will flood the world with the pastimes of Radha and Krishna.
164. Near the bank of the Ganga is a place called Chakhandi;
there lives a worthy brahmana named Chaitanya Dasa.

165. To him a son, Srinivasa, will be born, prema in form;
he will appear in the form of a Vaishnava."
166. Having written the letter thus, he sent it to Gauda,
and having made prema manifest he remained at peace.
167. At this time a letter came from Sanatana;
he wrote in full about the arrival of Gopala Bhatta.
168. Hearing of Gopala's arrival in Vrindavana,
the Lord was overjoyed together with his devotees.
169. "Listen, listen, Svarupa and Ramananda, to the news:
Gopala Bhatta has come to Vrindavana."
170. The Lord spoke much of the Bhatta's greatness,
and all rejoiced to hear it from the Lord's mouth.
171. The Lord said: "Consider now what I should do:
what thing of unprecedented sweetness shall I send?"
172. I am a poor sannyasi; I have no wealth;
all I have is my cord²⁸ and a seat to sit on.
173. In them is my power — hear the reason;
these two things I will give to the Bhatta,
174. so that he may sit on it in Rupa's company.
I will have Svarupa write the letter."
175. But to Sanatana the Lord himself wrote in his own hand:
"Let Rupa take up the describing of the pastimes in scriptures.
176. This letter of mine, read it out to Rupa;
hearing it, your hearts will rejoice.
177. In Gauda I will cause a jewel of a vessel to be born;
when his body is grown and fit, I will send him to you later.
178. His name is Srinivasa, born in a brahmana family;
he will make known in Gauda the very heart of Radha and Krishna's pastimes.
179. When I am no longer present, he will go to Vrindavana;
you shall entrust your books to him.
180. To Gauda I have sent Nityananda,
and with him Ramadasa, Gadadhara and Sundarananda.
181. For a son Chaitanya Dasa stayed in Nilachala;
Jagannatha gave prema, and he accepted it.
182. I too am coming soon to see you all;
make a secluded place for me in some grove.
183. Only Svarupa and Ramananda Raya are with me;
it is by the kindness of these two that my life is kept.
184. I am sending you the seat by a Vaishnava's hand,
and through Ramananda I have given him money for the road."
185. Taking the cord and the seat, the Vaishnava went to Vrindavana.
That day Rupa and Sanatana were together.

186. On receiving the letter the two brothers rejoiced,
and seeing the cord and the seat they swooned in prema.
187. Placing the cord round their necks, they wept a long while
and fell to the ground, crying "Gaurahari!"
188. "Shall we ever again see, Lord, the face of Gora-chand?
Not hearing your sweet words, our breasts are breaking!"
189. Rolling on the ground, they wept, clasping the seat to their breasts,
and perceived the sweet fragrance of his holy body.
190. At that moment Bhugarbha and Lokanatha arrived
and fell to the ground, a hand pressed to the breast.
191. In passing I will write something — listen, hearers —
a mere particle about Lokanatha's renunciation.
192. With no companion at all, he sits in seclusion;
with eyes closed, now he weeps and now he laughs.
193. Lokanatha Gosani is most deeply dear to the Lord;
Rupa and Sanatana honour him constantly.
194. Such will be his disciple Narottama;
he will make prema manifest on earth.
195. Narottama by name, a resident of Garerhat,²⁹
the son of Krishnananda Raya, a treasury of prema.
196. As Rupa and Sanatana are one body,
so, know for certain, are Narottama and Srinivasa.
197. Narottama, whose name Gauranga himself gave —
what shall I say of his virtues? They are all beyond compare.
198. That same power, those same pastimes he spread abroad;
who can be compared with such a chosen one?
199. The virtues of the two Mahashayas cannot be written —
of those who made prema manifest in Gauda.
200. The virtues of the two Mahashayas that are recorded
I shall write later, following in their wake.
201. Now I shall write of the pain of separation that befell;
seeing it, how could a poor, wretched person keep alive?
202. Seeing Sanatana's state, Rupa was stunned:
"If you become like this, everyone will die!"
203. You are the Lord's second body, Mahashaya;
seeing you so distraught, who can keep his senses?"
204. With many efforts Rupa brought him back to consciousness,
but the dreadful trembling of separation grew twofold.
205. From that day Sanatana had no rest:
the malady of separation from Gauranga grew twofold.
206. Seeing Sanatana, Rupa grew anxious
lest Govinda leave this Vrindavana empty.³⁰

207. Regaining his composure, Rupa took the seat
and went reverently to the Bhatta.
208. The two brothers, carefully holding the two things to their breasts,
went in great happiness to the Bhatta's lodging.
209. Prostrating themselves, they gave him the seat and the cord,
and reading the letter they made him hear the sweetness of prema.
210. Hearing the honour the letter did him, the Bhatta swooned,
and then, clasping the seat to his breast, he began to weep.
211. With care Sri Rupa steadied him somewhat,
and on seeing Sanatana the Bhatta grew calm.
212. Sanatana said: "Listen, Bhatta Gosani:
at the time of discourse sit on this seat — there is no fault in it."
213. "How can I sit on the Lord's seat?" —
"The Lord has commanded it — how can you disregard it?"
214. "The Lord's command is mightiest," said Sri Rupa;
and placing the cord round his neck, the Bhatta sat on the seat.
215. All their hearts were filled with joy,
and they went off each to his own grove.
216. That night, as Sanatana slept, in the guise of a dream
Gaurangachandra, embracing his neck, said:
217. "There is a brahmana youth named Srinivasa,
endowed with the greatest steadiness and other virtues.
218. You are my second body, Sanatana;
through Srinivasa you shall accomplish my purpose."
219. Having seen the dream, Sanatana rejoiced,
and in the morning, sitting in the assembly, he began to tell it.
220. Sanatana said: "Listen to a wondrous account:
the Lord is going to depart, and there is a reason for it.
221. The pastimes of Radha and Krishna, through sankirtana,
the Lord savours together with Svarupa and the others.
222. The pastimes that he will describe by infusing his power into Rupa
he will make known by sending a vessel.
223. There is a brahmana youth named Srinivasa;
through him the Lord will spread these pastimes in Gauda.
224. As prema in form he will cause him to be born in Gauda,
and Srinivasa will come here when the Lord's pastimes are ended.
225. You, staying in Vrindavana, will see him;
whether I am alive or not, he will be seen.
226. To see one chosen by Chaitanya's mercy is a matter of fortune,
and I suppose that such fortune is not mine.
227. If Chaitanya's mercy rests on everyone,
then in due time you will all see him in your midst."

228. The Bhatta said: "The Lord will send such a treasure —
if fortune allows, I shall see him with my own eyes."
229. Rupa said: "I have laboured by the Lord's power;
my labour will bear fruit if he comes soon.
230. While I live I will entrust everything to him,
and teaching him all the books, I will make him a pandit."
231. Thus all rejoiced together,
knowing that he would deliver the poor, the wretched and the wicked.
232. From then on Gopala Bhatta made it his rule
to keep all his observances with the cord tied round his neck.
233. One day in the assembly he raised the matter
of what he had seen of Srinivasa in a dream that night:
234. "In Chaitanya Dasa's house, in Lakshmipriya's womb...
As soon as he is born he will proclaim the name of Radha and Krishna,
235. and joyfully he will deliver all, down to the chandalas."
It turned out that they had all seen this in a dream.
236. All at once it dawned on them all:
they had seen a joyful dream and understood its reason.
237. Yet all were anxious about the Lord:
"We cannot understand what he intends by this."
238. So Sanatana and Rupa remained anxious:
when would Srinivasa come, the embodiment of prema?
239. And in Nilachala Svarupa's mind was uneasy:
night and day he saw inauspicious dreams.
240. One day Svarupa found the Lord alone
and asked him: "Who is this Srinivasa?
241. Tell me his virtues in detail, Prabhu;
merely to hear of his virtues gladdens the heart."
242. On hearing the name, Svarupa's joy grew,³¹
and he wrote a letter to Sanatana once more.
243. A wondrous letter he wrote to Sanatana:
"Reading it, he will understand the whole matter."
244. Meanwhile, in his own house, the brahmana Chaitanya Dasa
was performing purashcharana for the sake of a son.
245. Seven purashcharanas he performed near the Ganga,
and in a dream a command came to him from One of golden form:
246. "A wondrous son named Srinivasa will be born,
and through him prema will be made manifest."
247. To Lakshmipriya the command was given with a hand laid on her head:
"A wondrous son will be born — remain joyful."
248. At the mere touch of the Lord's hand she became mad with prema;
coming to herself, Lakshmipriya began to weep.

249. Tears, trembling, hair standing on end — and she lost all composure:
Lakshmipriya's body was filled with prema.
250. Lakshmipriya said: "Acharya, pay heed:
see, a great being dwells within my body.
251. I laugh, I weep, I dance, I sing — such is my state;
all sorrow is gone, I tell you.
252. Do not go anywhere and leave me;
perform nama-sankirtana at home day and night."
253. The Acharya said: "How shall we get by?³²
There is no wealth in the house — what shall we eat?"
254. Lakshmipriya said: "I have gained great wealth:
your poverty is at an end, your life is fulfilled."
255. The village had suffered oppression from the ruler and many troubles;
now it had all calmed down, and the ruler had become well-disposed.
256. The zamindar had left the village and was living in another,
but now that the trouble was over he was to return to his own place.
257. As soon as he³³ entered the womb, hearts were filled with prema and joy,
and all fear of the yavanas went away without effort.
258. Until then people had kept saying "Durga, Shiva";
now no one uttered any name but Krishna's.
259. There was an old brahmana there of wicked ways;
he whispered slander into the zamindar's ear:
260. "The village will be ruined, brother, by this name;
forbid the people!" — so he came and said.
261. "They have left Shiva and Durga and keep saying...³⁴
I will plunder their homes — by what strength will they keep them?"
262. Calling the kotal³⁵ and a drummer, Durgadas said:
"Let them say 'Shiva, Durga!' — or else it is ruin for all!"
263. The drummer struck his drum for the first time —
and the drum began to sound "Radha-Krishna"!
264. Children dance in prema, saying "Radha-Krishna";
women dance, with longing in their hearts.
265. At the sound of the drum all the people became intoxicated
and, saying "Radha-Krishna," began to dance.
266. The drummer, possessed by prema, dances, weeps and laughs;
the boys dance and tumble down.
267. At the sound of the drum all the people were intoxicated
and danced merrily along with the children.
268. Dancing, they came to Chaitanya Dasa's house;
seeing the zamindar, the brahmana grew anxious at heart.
269. With honour he seated him on a seat,
and in his flurry knew not what to do or say.

270. Courteously he dismissed the people³⁶
and with honour had Durgadas bathe.
271. A great deal of food came together,
and the Acharya brought it and set it before Durgadas.
272. Seeing the provisions, Durgadas was pleased,
and seeing such things in a poor man's house he smiled gently.
273. Having eaten, the Raya stayed in the Acharya's house
and lay down to rest with joy in his heart.
274. In the night came the sound of khol and kartals;
heavy with sleep, at the mere hearing of the sound
275. he awoke — but could hear nothing more;
and the Raya fell senseless where he was.
276. Lakshmi priya says: "Acharya, attend:
two golden children are dancing in sankirtana!"
277. The two golden children together,
laughing and laughing, laid their feet upon her head.³⁷
278. And the command came: "For ten months take care of yourself;
once again I shall dance in your courtyard."³⁸
279. Durgadas, sitting up on his bed, beheld it;
he heard every word — he saw it in a dream.
280. Intoxicated with prema, the Raya cried out and wept,
fell to the ground and could not be calmed.
281. In haste the Acharya lifted him and took him in his arms:
"Be steady, Raya," he said to him gently.
282. "I do not know what sound I heard ringing in my ears;
when I came to, I do not know where it had gone."
283. The Acharya said: "In a dream I saw what those two were like;
my sleep broke — where has such a treasure gone?"
284. The Raya said: "It was no dream — why do you dissemble?
Be kind and tell me; it will make me very happy."
285. The Acharya said: "Raya, you are a very sober man;
why should seeing a dream unsettle you so?"
286. The Raya said: "It was no dream; I saw it with my own eyes:
I found the Creator, and he left me bereft."
287. The Raya said: "Acharya, I will confess to you:
I have forgotten my own chosen deity, and I do not know why.
288. Having seen the dream I have forgotten my chosen deity:
the name of Radha and Krishna has entered my body.
289. To abandon one's chosen deity is death, as the shastras attest;
I have heard this word from the shastras; it cannot be otherwise."
290. The Acharya said: "Raya, you are very learned;
consider, and do whatever your mind accepts."

291. The Raya said: "I have heard people say
that in Navadvipa the Creator was born in the form of Gaura.
292. That same Creator has entered my heart,
and entering in the night, he made me forget my own deity.
293. That same Creator danced in your courtyard:
I saw two golden ones in my dream.
294. What am I to do? Give me your counsel."
The Acharya said: "You are the ruler, and I am under your protection."
295. The Raya said: "I have told you everything as it was;
it is in my mind to take the mantra of Radha and Krishna."
296. So saying, the Raya went to his residence,
and set his mind on taking a guru in a worthy place.
297. Finding a worthy place, the Raya received instruction.
Merely from his entering the womb, such was the fruit!
298. To such a Srinivasa's feet I bow:
from the womb he flooded the world with the name of Radha and Krishna.³⁹
299. In Navadvipa the Lord could not make every being take the Name,
but Srinivasa from the womb made them take it in Chakhandi.⁴⁰
300. Even pashandis openly take the name of Krishna —
so great a dawning of the Lord through Srinivasa!
301. There has been no such avatara, brothers, in any yuga;
yet we, not honouring the two brothers, feed upon poison.
302. Worship, worship, O brothers, Chaitanya and Nitai:
such a merciful Thakura I have never seen.
303. Meanwhile Lakshmipriya and the Acharya rejoiced:
the bodies of both were filled with prema.
304. Whoever got anything anywhere brought it and gave it;
poverty vanished, and everyone was glad.
305. When ten months and ten days were complete,
at an auspicious moment the boy was born.
306. On the full moon of Vaishakha,⁴¹ on an auspicious day at an auspicious moment,
Lakshmipriya beheld her son's face.
307. The Acharya entered the room,
and seeing his son's face he was filled with great joy.
308. Brahmanas recite the Vedas, bards their songs of praise;⁴²
in the sky the gods utter blessings.
309. The women raise the auspicious ulu-ulu cry;
old men and children dance and clap their hands.
310. Lowing, the cows with their calves
roam about with tails held high and grass in their mouths.
311. The villagers bring gifts, filling their plates;
everyone gives, rejoicing greatly.

312. Durgadas Raya, bringing musicians and instruments,
came to the Acharya's house uttering blessings.
313. Coming into the courtyard, he began to dance at length
and distributed many gifts to the brahmanas.
314. No sound was heard but "Radha-Krishna,"
and a voice from the sky said: "Sing, sing!"
315. *Today there is no end to my joy:
after so many days Madhava is in my house!* (refrain)⁴³
316. Having this song sung, he began to dance;
there was no bound to the joy, and so the day ended.
317. With his people the Raya went back to his home,
and brahmanas and good folk came thronging.
318. For the son's welfare they made offerings to the brahmana:
whatever wealth they had at home they brought and laid before him.
319. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the first vilasa, called "The Description of the Birth of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura".

1. A Sanskrit verse prefixed to the poem; in the 1913 edition it is preceded by the usual invocation "Obeisance to Sri Krishna-Chaitanya-chandra".
2. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition; in the 1999 reprint its first line has dropped out.
3. The five kinds of mukti are salokya, sarshiti, sarupya, samipya and sayujya.
4. The beginning of the line is corrupt in both copies ("dā" / "di ri"); translated by the general sense ("I cannot believe").
5. The Garuda pillar (garuda-stambha) in the Jagannatha temple at Puri, beside which Mahaprabhu used to behold the Deity.
6. Kashi Mishra, in whose house Mahaprabhu lived at Puri.
7. Variant: "if he behaves unreasonably, I will bind him and bring him."
8. Avani, "Earth"; the Earth (Prithivi) appears here as a goddess.
9. Variant: "embraced the Earth".
10. The sense of the line is unclear; perhaps "nothing was said of the measure of the vessel's worth, nor of his name".
11. A watch (prahara) is about three hours; the third watch of the day falls in the afternoon.
12. Variant: "some ignorant people".
13. Both copies read "baḍa ajña sei loka bhaṭṭa ānāila", literally "the Bhatta had those very ignorant people brought"; translated by the sense.
14. So according to the variant reading; the main text has "the chief cause of it is the rule of the kings".
15. That is, that grace (prema) be given to all without distinction.
16. The long garland hanging from Jagannatha's neck; its falling is a sign of the Deity's assent.
17. Literally "that most worthy vessel, full of the form of prema"; the future son, Srinivasa, is meant.
18. Balarama (Balarama Dasa), a brahmana, Lakshmipriya's father; not to be confused with Balarama as Nityananda. In the 1913 edition this couplet is set in brackets.
19. Variant: "repeat it to the Lord".
20. Advaita's famous "riddle" (tarja), sent through Jagadananda (cf. Chaitanya-charitamrita, Antya 19): "Tell the Baul that the people have gone mad; tell the Baul that rice no longer sells in the market..." — a hint that Mahaprabhu's mission was complete.
21. In Sanskrit in the original: "yat kathitaṃ tat phalitaṃ".
22. Variant: "do not forsake us who have taken shelter with you".
23. Variant: "trembles".

24. In the 1913 edition this line too is set in brackets.
25. Purashcharana, a vow of repeating a mantra a great number of times for a specific end.
26. Variant of the second line: "You will not be able to bear this weight of prema."
27. "Premera vilasa", a play on the title of the poem (Prema-vilasa).
28. Dor, a sannyasi's waist-cord (sometimes understood as a cord of beads).
29. Garerhat (Gaderhat), the district where Kheturi, Narottama's home, lay.
30. That is, lest Sanatana leave his body; Govinda here is the Deity of Vrindavana served by Rupa and Sanatana; the sense of the line is somewhat unclear.
31. Variant: "anxiety".
32. The 1999 edition reads "nidrā kemane haiba", "how shall I sleep?"; in the 1913 edition the word is corrupt. Translated by the sense of the second line.
33. Srinivasa.
34. The line is corrupt in both copies; only the discernible sense is given.
35. The kotal was the village watchman, who announced orders to the people by beat of drum.
36. This line is found only in the 1913 edition.
37. Literally "held the feet at the head"; it may also be understood as "bowed their heads to her feet".
38. Couplets 276–278 are set in brackets in the 1913 edition.
39. Variant: "spreading bhakti, he delivered the world".
40. Variant of the second line: "the Mahashaya would be born to deliver the world".
41. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition. The full moon of Vaishakha falls in April–May.
42. "Raybar", songs of praise sung by court bards (bhats).
43. A song (pada); cf. Vidyapati's well-known line "cira-dine mādharma mandire mora".
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Vilasa 2. The Description of the Festival of Srinivasa Acharya's Birth

Chakhandi rejoices at Srinivasa's birth: the father gazes on his son's face; music, dancing and crowds of people who forget their sorrows

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya Acharya, glory, glory!
Glory, glory to Lakshmipriya of compassionate heart!
2. Glory, glory to the listeners — listen with care,
you whose life's treasure is the pastimes of Radha and Krishna's prema.
3. Hearing of the son's birth, people forgot their sorrow and grief;
men and women set out to see him.
The lame, the dull-witted and the blind run along, singing the virtues of Radha and Krishna,
forgetting home and sons.¹
4. The Acharya went into the room, his eyes brimming with joy:
he beholds his son's moon-like face.
Tears flow from his eyes; gazing, he is beside himself,
again and again offering up his life for him.²
5. Having seen, he cannot come away; tears stream from both his eyes:
"Blessed is the mother who bore him in her womb!"
Whether gandharva or kinnara — there is none to compare him with;
and he sank into the ocean of prema.
6. The dancing girls dance, and all the dancers
dance and sing in the sweetest voices.
The bhats recite many wondrous pastimes of Krishna,
their bodies thrilling with delight.
7. Mridanga, jhanjh and dhol — the music is a tumult;
kartals and pakhoajs are played.
Mahuri and pinaka sound, damp and saptasvara thunder;³
the sound pierces the sky.
8. The blind and the deaf count themselves blessed,
yet they too reproach Providence:
"I would have gazed my fill — in such sorrow I die!
O Fate, you are pitiless!"
9. So saying they dance and sing, weep and roll on the ground,
exulting and crying "Radha-Krishna!"
Hundreds of thousands of people run, casting off fear, sorrow and grief;
many worldly men and pandits run too.
10. Bodies were filled with joy, homes were filled with wealth and grain,
and all swooned in prema.⁴
11. Such is the birth of Srinivasa — I have told it to you, brothers;
whoever hears it, his life is fulfilled.
Nityananda Dasa in his song will distribute the wealth of prema,
to purify his own body.

12. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the second vilasa, called "The Description of the Festival of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura's Birth".

1. Stanzas 3–11 are in tripadi metre.

2. "Nichhiya nichhiya": the nichhani rite, in which one circles the hand round a child as though giving up one's own life for it, to ward off misfortune.

3. Mahuri, a reed wind instrument like the oboe; pinaka, a stringed instrument; damph, a frame drum; saptasvara, an instrument "of seven notes".

4. The stanza survives only as a half; in the 1913 edition its opening words ("ānande purila deha") have been displaced to the top of the page.

Vilasa 3. The Interruption of Srinivasa's Studies

The author's address on the cause of his writing; Srinivasa's childhood — the first rice and the sacred thread; the break in his studies and the boy's grief; his teacher Dhananjaya admits that the pupil has surpassed him; Sarasvati, by Chaitanya's command, bestows all learning on Srinivasa

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya Acharya, glory, glory!
Glory, glory to Lakshmipriya of compassionate heart!
2. Glory, glory to the listeners — listen with care,
you whose life's treasure is the pastimes of Radha and Krishna's prema.
3. Of one shortcoming of mine I will write once:¹
at the feet of Krishna's devotees I bow.
4. I have not studied, and there is not a trace of bhakti in me;
yet I write by the command of the Ocean of compassion:
5. "All my devotees who wander upon the earth
descended along with me and bear the same virtues.
6. Some have described the pastimes of Radha and Krishna,
others have revealed scriptures about Gaura's pastimes.
7. Whoever writes of the virtues of Krishna's devotees,
to him I show mercy with a joyful heart.
8. After my departure there will be prema upon the earth;
I bid you write and describe their virtues.
9. Srinivasa and Narottama are the two Mahashayas;
write of the virtues of these two abundantly.
10. Write of the virtues of both and of their way of bhajana —
how the earth spread prema in their form."
11. I have never known a speck of the gift of description;
yet I write by the strength of the command of the two Lords.
12. Sri Jahnava and Virachandra, at whose feet my hope rests —
from them came the command to reveal these virtues.
13. Srinivasa is my breath, Narottama my life;
with care I write of the virtues of these two.
14. By that command I write whatever words come to my mind;
O Vaishnava Gosanis, do not count it against me in any way.
15. For six months the Acharya did not go out anywhere;
seeing his son's power, he remained at peace.
16. Both rejoiced as they looked on their son's face,
and raised their son with happy hearts.
17. The time of the annaprashana² came;
they brought an astrologer and fixed the day firmly.
18. At an auspicious moment they put prasada into the son's mouth,
and both rejoiced, clasping their son to their breasts.

19. The time of the chudakarana³ came;
performing the rites according to rule, they gave him the sacred thread.
20. A crimson cloth gleams upon his body;
seeing him, his father and mother rejoice at heart.
21. On the third day the Thakura grew restless:
his lessons had stopped — he stayed at home and began to weep.⁴
22. At this time the pandit Vidyanidhi came by;⁵
hearing of the break in the lessons, he was greatly pleased:
23. "The boy has such a longing for learning —
it seems Srinivasa will become an expert in the sciences."
24. One night Srinivasa saw in a dream:
"Study quickly, Srinivasa — you will go to Vrindavana.
25. Gauda is very dear to Chaitanya;
through you he will make books of the pastimes arise here.
26. Why have you stopped studying for three days?
At your parents' word I will teach you.
27. But if you act against this word,
what you have learned will not come back to your mind."⁶
28. He constantly uttered the name of Radha and Krishna with his tongue,
and so his learning went — he did not go to study.
29. Lakshmipriya and the Acharya were astonished:
they could not understand what kind of birth this was.⁷
30. He constantly uttered the name of Radha and Krishna with his tongue,
and so his learning went — yet there was joy in his heart.
31. Sitting at home, what does Srinivasa say?
"I have not become a pandit" — such is the pain in his mind.
32. "I cannot understand Krishna's mercy;
scholarship comes from study — such is its way."⁸
33. Therefore I will not live in Yajigrama:
for the sake of learning I will go to another land."
34. After ten days his mother bade him:
"Go and study, my son; your lessons have been interrupted."
35. "As you command," he said, and taking a book in his hand,
Srinivasa went to his guru's place.
36. Dhananjaya Vidyanivasa said a wondrous thing:
"Looking at your form, I feel joy.
37. Listen, listen, Srinivasa, I will tell you:
learning no longer comes alive in me — why have you come?
38. You have stolen all my learning;
I am an empty body, I tell you.
39. I cannot understand your nature;
it seems Sarasvati has turned against me."

40. Ashamed, Srinivasa bowed to his guru,
and Dhananjaya started up in fear, crying "Alas, alas!"
41. Srinivasa's shame grew all the more, doubling;
dejected, he tied up his book and went away.
42. His father and mother knew nothing of all this;
grieving over the break in his studies, he lay down alone.
43. The meal was ready, but the boy was not at home;
his father went to look for him with an anxious heart.
44. The pandit said: "He left a long time ago."
Finding no trace of him, the father was greatly distressed.
45. Going into the house, he entered the room
and saw him asleep with a book in his hand.
46. Hearing his father's voice, out of shame he said nothing,
and saying "Give me food, Mother," began to laugh.
47. Having eaten, Srinivasa rinsed his mouth
and, laughing, lay down again.
48. Suddenly a voice from heaven was heard in the room —
the sound came: "All learning shall awaken in you!"
49. I am Sarasvati; by Chaitanya's command
I have come in the guise of a dream to give you learning."
50. Opening his eyes, he looks — there is no one in the room.
"By the goddess's boon I shall have great learning!"
51. Laughing, he came out happily
and stood before his father and mother.
52. "Come, come, my son, let me take you on my lap;
do not grieve over the break in your studies," and she kissed his cheek.⁹
53. From then on there was no further break in his studies,
and beyond that, the name of Radha and Krishna awoke in him.
54. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the third vilasa, containing the description of the interruption of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura's studies.

1. Variant: "Do not hold the irregularities of my writing against me."

2. Annaprashana, a child's first feeding with rice.

3. Chudakarana, the rite of the first tonsure; the sacred thread is normally given at the upanayana, but the text runs the two rites together.

4. After the upanayana a boy customarily spends some days in seclusion and does not go to his teacher.

5. Variant: "Sri Rama Vachaspati came by".

6. Variant: "you will forget what you have learned". Who speaks in the dream is not stated; from the context, apparently the teacher.

7. In the 1913 edition this couplet is in brackets.

8. The second line is unclear; literally "having studied, his scholarship in such conduct".

9. In the 1913 edition this couplet is in brackets.

Vilasa 4. Srinivasa's Wanderings: Srikhanda, Puri, Navadvipa, Shantipur

Srinivasa meets Narahari Sarakara; longing for Mahaprabhu and a voice from the sky; the death of Chaitanya Dasa; the move to Yajigrama; Srikhanda and Raghunandana; the journey to Puri and Gadadhara's passing; Navadvipa and Vishnupriya's grace; Shantipur: the vision of Advaita and Sita's account

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. One morning, as Srinivasa was going to bathe,
he met Sarakara Thakura¹ on the road.
3. He was on his way from Gajipur to Khanda,
and he saw a wondrous form of golden hue.
4. Suddenly the Lord's feet came to his mind:
it seemed to him that he had seen that very form in person.
5. "Srinivasa is his name, born in a brahmana family" —
seeing the boy's radiance, the Thakura grasped the secret.
6. "If I ask his name, I shall learn who he is," he thought;
and the boy, prostrating himself, stood before him.
7. In a sweet voice he began to ask him:
"What is your name, boy? Tell me truly."
8. Respectfully Srinivasa answered:
"Your own servant, born at Chakhandi."
9. Hearing the name Srinivasa, the Thakura was delighted
and became firmly convinced that this was Chaitanya's power.
10. "Come, come, my son, let me embrace you!" —
and holding him to his breast, he bathed him in tears.
11. "Nityananda is anxious about you."²
I had a wish, and now I have met you.
12. I had heard nothing of you from anyone, nor seen you;
I cannot tell how much hidden treasure lies in this.
13. Virachandra called me in Jahnava's presence:
'Send Srinivasa to Vrindavana quickly.'
14. He was born on the bank of the Ganga and is still a mere child —
that is why I have not met him.
15. Without any effort Chaitanya has brought us together on this road;
through you he will reveal the pastimes in Vrindavana.
16. Now there is no need to ask anything more;
meeting you in Khanda will make me happy."
17. The Thakura went on to Khanda, and Srinivasa crossed the Ganga;
and at home his father and mother were sorely anxious.³

18. On reaching home the boy lost all composure in prema:
he laughs, weeps, dances, sings and falls to the ground again and again.
19. Crying out, he weeps very loudly,
and a great lamentation arose in the Acharya's house.
20. "Why has this happened to him? We know nothing;
when we ask, he weeps the more," and their hearts were torn.
21. The Acharya heard the weeping inside the house
and saw his son weeping with an anguished heart.
22. He asked: "My son, why are you weeping?
You went to bathe — why do you weep? I do not understand."
23. One by one the villagers gathered,
and seeing the boy's behaviour they cried out in dismay.
24. Among them was an old brahmana:
"Be patient; listen, I will tell you the cause of this.
25. Narahari Thakura Mahashaya, who lives in Khanda,
met the boy on the road at the time of his bath.
26. From seeing him the boy has come into this state;
do not worry, be patient," he said truly.
27. Hearing the name of Narahari, the boy laughed,
and at the brahmana's words regained some outward awareness.
28. But from that day his state was changed:
the malady of separation from Chaitanya grew twofold.
29. "I never had the sight of Chaitanya Prabhu,
I never saw the feet of Nityananda Prabhu,
30. I did not see the form of Advaita Acharya,
I did not meet Svarupa, Ramananda Raya, Sanatana or Rupa,
31. I did not hear sankirtana together with the devotees —
sinner that I am, I was not born at that time!"
32. Lifting his face to the sky, he cried out long:
"By giving me a later birth, Fate has barred my happiness!"
33. Then a voice sounded from the sky:
"Your birth is in the form of prema — why do you worry?
34. Through you the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will be spread;
with what Chaitanya savoured you will flood the world.
35. In Vrindavana Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, have written scriptures of rasa for your sake.
36. Foreseeing the future, Chaitanya Gosani, for your sake,
sent the two brothers to compose these books.
37. The two brothers are anxious in Vrindavana;
if you go quickly, you will see them.
38. If you delay, you will not see the two brothers,
and when you reach Vrindavana your sorrow will be all the greater."

39. "The grief in my father's and mother's hearts — this is my great dilemma;
if only the Mahashaya would help me in this!"
40. For a while he grew calm, and the people went home;
seeing him well, his father and mother were glad at heart.
41. Understanding his father's heart, Srinivasa smiled
and asked to eat: "I am very hungry."
42. At their son's words they were overjoyed
and lovingly fed him many dishes.
43. "While my father and mother live, how can I leave them?
Besides, I am only a boy — how shall I go to Vrindavana?"
44. But Chaitanya's mercy is very deep;
all sorrow vanished, and there was joy in his heart.
45. Suddenly a fever came upon Chaitanya Dasa,
and within seven days he attained the Ganga.⁴
46. Seeing this, Srinivasa wept much in his grief,
and then performed the prescribed rites with special care.
47. At the loss of his father he suffered great sorrow,
and seeing his mother weep, his face withered.
48. "To the childless the Lord gave a son, Srinivasa,
and now bereavement has come, and our hope is unfulfilled.
49. O cruel Fate, what shall I say to you?
So soon you have given the boy such sorrow!
50. My diamond of a boy⁵ — how will his days pass?
We have no one to call our own — what will become of me?
51. O Srinivasa, where has your father gone?
How shall we pass our days? We are orphaned!"
52. Seeing his mother's grief, Srinivasa was stricken
and wept long, crying "Father, father!
53. With whom have you left me, where have you gone?⁶
You loved me so, Thakura, and yet you have left me!"
54. Thus, after lamenting long on the bank of the Ganga,
he performed the rites according to rule and gave the bones to the water.
55. Coming home, he wept a great deal,
and women came to console Lakshmipriya.
56. "Listen, listen, Thakurani, why do you grieve?
Look at your son and restrain yourself.
57. What comfort can we give? Listen, steady your heart;
look at your son and forget your sorrow; do not weep."
58. At this time a voice sounded from the sky:
"Why do you grieve, mother, why are you anxious?
59. You know nothing of the boy's virtues;
when you go to Yajigrama, you will learn everything later.

60. For the sake of these two⁷ Sri Chaitanya and Nityananda
began the books in Vrindavana through Rupa.
61. Take care of your son — listen, Lakshmi-priya;
do not grieve in vain; be steady of heart."
62. All her grief for her husband went away,
but in her breast remained a sprout of sorrow over Srinivasa.
63. Having duly performed all the customary observances,
Srinivasa visited Yajigrama and saw Narahari.⁸
64. A great longing arose in him: "I will leave this village;
settling my mother in Yajigrama, I will go elsewhere."
65. At night, as he slept in the village,
the command of Chaitanya came in a dream: "Go to Vrindavana."
66. Having seen the dream, he awoke:
"How can I go so soon and leave her?"
67. Besides, I have not yet received initiation;
I have no right to go to Vrindavana.
68. Delay is not good; I will go and settle there,
and then follow whatever counsel Thakura Narahari gives me."
69. After living some days in Chakhandi,
he left that place and came to Yajigrama.
70. On the fifth day of the month of Phalguna they settled there,
and at that time he met the zamindar of the village.
71. Seeing his radiance, the zamindar showed him honour:
"Live in this village — I will build you a house."
72. Seeing his wondrous form, he counted himself fortunate:
"We too are blessed; our life is fulfilled!"
73. Thus he stayed some days in that village,
and then the wish arose in him to go to Khanda.
74. He chose and made ready a very charming place —
a beautiful dwelling on the western side of the village.⁹
75. Leaving his mother in that village, he went to Khanda.
At the outer gate, under a tree, sat Sri Raghunandana.
76. Seeing his radiance, he asked: "What is your name?
Where have you come from? Tell me your news."
77. "I have just come from Yajigrama for darshan;
my name is Srinivasa," he answered respectfully.
78. Hearing the name Srinivasa, Raghunandana was overcome with prema;
stretching out his arms, he came and embraced him.
79. "From the Thakura's holy lips I have heard all about you;
at the mere sight of you all my distress has gone.
80. Come, come, brother, to the Thakura;
we two will have our talk later."

81. Taking him by the hand, he led him to the Thakura.
"Come, come, my son, sit down, Srinivasa!
82. A letter has come from Virachandra about you:
'Send Srinivasa to Vrindavana quickly.'"
83. Kindly he passed his holy hand over his body,
and at the touch of that holy hand Srinivasa was deeply absorbed in prema.
84. Nearby was Nayana Sena Mahashaya;¹⁰
supporting Srinivasa, he took him to his own house.
85. That day he was holding the worship of his guru and his father's memorial rite;
in the afternoon the Thakura came to his house with Raghunandana.
86. "Tell me, tell me, Nayana, where is Srinivasa?
Bring him — I will ask him about going to Vrindavana."
87. Then Srinivasa, seeing Narahari,
bowed to him, and he was glad to see his smiling face.
88. "Tell me, Srinivasa, about your going to Vrindavana:
how will you manage it, my son? Tell me in detail."
89. "Listen, Thakura, I must tell you:
without a refuge,¹¹ how can I do this?"
90. "Concerning you, Chaitanya gave the Bhatta a command:
he will give you initiation in every way."
91. Weeping, Srinivasa said:
"Why do you deceive me and send me to Vrindavana?"
92. Coming from Chakhandi I received your darshan,
and at that very moment I surrendered myself to you."
93. The Thakura said: "What you say is true;
but Gopala Bhatta is your guru, I tell you.
94. I cannot go against the Lord's command.
For now live here and serve.
95. Hari-nama is Mahaprabhu's own power;
understanding this, you shall receive it."
96. Having heard this, he went to his lodging
and began to ponder what Sarakara Thakura had said.
97. "From whom shall I receive Hari-nama?" —
turning this over in his mind, he lay awake all night.
98. Towards the end of the night his sleep broke, and he was half awake,¹²
and Gaurachandra mercifully said to him:
99. "Listen, listen, Srinivasa, why are you troubled?
You were born as prema in form for my purpose.
100. Why, then, do you wait?¹³
I have told you: you were born as prema in form.
101. Go to Vrindavana; do not delay;
take refuge at the feet of Gopala Bhatta.

102. He was born in the land of Telanga; he is my very life;
and Sanatana and Rupa are one soul in two bodies.
103. All the books that Rupa and Sanatana have written
they will entrust to you when you go.
104. They are anxious at your delay;
the work is done — go quickly."
105. In ecstasy he bowed to the Lord,
who laid a hand on his head and said: "May your heart's desire be fulfilled."
106. The Lord vanished, and his sleep was broken;
waking, Srinivasa reflected:
107. "The Lord has commanded me to go to Vrindavana."
And he went and told Sarakara Thakura.
108. Thinking thus, Srinivasa came to Narahari,
bowed to him and offered him praise:
109. "Listen, Mahashaya, to what I saw in a dream:
a golden-bodied boy came and spoke to me..."
110. All that he had seen in the dream he told;
the Thakura said: "Mahaprabhu's mercy has come."
111. Laying a hand on his head, he blessed him:
"May Vrindavana show you mercy without delay.
112. I have sent a letter to Virachandra:
'I have kept Srinivasa with me — give your command.'
113. Whatever answer comes, I will act on it;
until then stay here, close to me."
114. Thus he lived some days in Khanda,
and a wish arose in him to see Jagannatha.
115. "I greatly wish to study the Bhagavata;
I will see Jagannatha and stay with the Pandita."¹⁴
116. Going to him I will study the Bhagavata,
and having studied it with commentary I will go to Vrindavana."
117. With this in mind he went to Narahari.
"What you have said, my son, is right.
118. I will give you a Vaishnava as a companion;
delivering a letter, he will give my news."
119. He put a respectful letter into the Vaishnava's hand,
and setting out, the two went along the road to Jagannatha.
120. Travelling on, they reached Jagannatha-puri,
and having seen Jagannatha they came to Gopinatha's abode."¹⁵
121. The Pandita Gosani was stricken in separation from Chaitanya:
now he swooned, now he laughed, and a stupor lay within him."¹⁶
122. Saying "Chaitanya! Nityananda!" Srinivasa prostrated himself;
hearing Chaitanya's name, Gosani was stirred.

123. "Who are you? Who are you?" he said, opening his eyes.
"Come, come, my son, let me hold you to my breast.
124. What is your name, my son? Tell me.
What wondrous words I have heard from your lips!
125. By letting me hear the Name you have bought me.¹⁷
With separation in my heart I saw a dream:
126. 'From Gauda will come one named Srinivasa,
born at Chakhandi as prema in form,
127. to his father Chaitanya Dasa, from the womb of Lakshmipriya,
so that the pastimes of Radha and Krishna may be spread.'
128. Are you that one, my son? Tell me who you are;
soothe my body — tell me for certain."
129. "I am he," he said, and smiled gently.
"You are the master, and I am wretched, luckless and low."
130. "It is good that you came, my son, and told me who you are.
The Lord commanded me to teach you the Bhagavata.
131. At the time of his last pastimes the Lord told me:
'When Srinivasa comes, let him hear Krishna's pastimes.
132. For his sake you shall stay at Gopinatha,
and send him to Vrindavana with a letter in his hand.
133. Sri Rupa and Sanatana, the two brothers,
have revealed the Lord's heart through their scriptures.
134. Those scriptures you¹⁸ will bring to Gauda,
and reveal the scriptures of the pastimes in every particular.'
135. The Lord's command is to teach you the Bhagavata,
but the letters of my book have all been washed away by my tears.
136. Give my letter into Narahari's hands;
he will send a new book with you.
137. The Lord's command concerning you is mighty;
do not delay; settle everything.
138. In the pastimes of Radha and Krishna there is Sri Guna-manjari —
she is none other than Gopala Bhatta, of equal sweetness."
139. "I will become his disciple, Prabhu!" — a great longing was in Srinivasa's heart,
and on hearing the name Guna-manjari his ears rejoiced.
140. "I see the Lord's command has been given to the Manjari;
in Navadvipa you will receive a witness from Ishvari-ji.¹⁹
141. Partake of the remnants of Gopinatha's meal;
today is an auspicious day — set out for Gauda.
142. If you delay on the road, you will not find them."
With closed eyes Srinivasa listened to these words.
143. "Where has Prabhu Chaitanya gone, where is Nityananda?" —
for a moment he weeps, then gently laughs.

144. Bearing the pain of separation, he loses all memory:
it does not occur to him that Gopinatha is before him.
145. The raving of separation, all kinds of changes in his body;
lifting his face, now and again he cries out.
146. Seeing these changes, Srinivasa was stunned:
"If I go to Gauda, I shall not see him again."
147. Taking the reply, he prostrated himself.
"Set out for your country, if you would study the Bhagavata."
148. Taking the road, he came to Narahari;
that day Virachandra was in the house, and many people had gathered.²⁰
149. Then the Mahashaya prostrated himself,
and the word was given: "Srinivasa, it is good that you have come.
150. Listen: this letter has come from Vrindavana —
study the Bhagavata and set out for Vrindavana."
151. He made known the Pandita Gosani's command in the letter
and told everything just as he had seen it.
152. He read the letter out to Virachandra Gosani
and asked leave to go and study the Bhagavata.
153. "If you delay, you will not find him;
go to the Kshetra without delay."
154. The Thakura again gave him the same Vaishnava as a companion,
and saying "Gadadhara! Chaitanya!" Srinivasa set out.
155. In anxiety Srinivasa went as far as Jajpur,
and as he entered the village he received the news that the Pandita had passed away.
156. Receiving the news, he swooned on the spot,
and the frightened Vaishnava clasped his feet.
157. Coming to himself, he bowed down many times:
"My purpose is not fulfilled — Fate has turned against me!"
158. That night he fasted there;
seeing how wasted he was, the Vaishnava was greatly afraid:
159. "How shall I bring him to Gauda?
The Thakura will punish me!" — and his heart sank.
160. With much care he got him to eat,
and entreating him, they went on to Gauda.
161. Weeping and weeping, he came back to Gauda,²¹
and in the afternoon entered the village of Srikhanda.
162. Prostrating himself, he told the whole story
and, crying "Alas!", wept long.
163. Who can describe that lament of separation —
the lament of one whose heart holds the grief of separation from guru and Vaishnavas?
164. From that day another state came over him again:
"How shall I get to Vrindavana?" — and his longing grew.

165. In the morning, leaving Srikhanda, he came to Navadvipa,
and living as a renunciant he stayed near the Lord's house.
166. Crying "Pandita Gosani!", he weeps aloud;
for two or four days at a time he takes no food.
167. When his hunger becomes unbearable,
he gathers a chhatak²² of rice,
168. cooks it on the bank of the Ganga,
but what he truly eats is the pain of separation.
169. By the eighth day his body was utterly wasted;
and he met Vamshivadana Dasa.
170. "What is your name? Where do you live? I have never seen or heard of you." —
"In separation from Gadadhara I am staying here.
171. My name is Srinivasa; my home is in Yajigrama;
I could not study the Bhagavata, and my heart is in pain.
172. Gadadhara Pandita had the Lord's command —
I would have studied with him, but by my misfortune it did not come to pass."
173. As he spoke, a great weeping overcame him.
At that moment Ishana arrived.
174. Such is Ishana's nature: he is compassionate to living beings,
and on seeing a great bhagavata, prema rises in him.
175. Seeing him so wasted, he questioned him,
and seeing him entirely alone, he was much pleased.²³
176. He understood that Chaitanya's power was in the boy:
"I ought to tell Ishvari of this."
177. He went back home to Ishvari:
"I have seen a wondrous boy at the bathing ghat on the Ganga.
178. He is always weeping, calling on Gadadhara Pandita;
he has no companion, and his eyes are full of tears.
179. Seeing him, I was moved to compassion:
without food his body has become utterly wasted.
180. If you permit, I will give him some food,
and later bring him here, and you may show him mercy."
181. "Go and give him rice, as much as is fitting;
but now that Chaitanya is gone, his renunciation troubles me."²⁴
182. Ishana took excellent provisions
and went joyfully to Srinivasa.
183. "Listen, brahmana: take these provisions,
go to the bank of the Ganga, cook them and eat."
184. "As you command," he said, and bowing he took them.
And here Ishvari herself understood everything.
185. Having given him rice, Ishvari rejoiced at heart:
"I see the boy has been born as prema in form."²⁵

186. When the brahmana took the rice and cooked it,
she sent ten vairagis to him.
187. When the food was ready, they came in the guise of vairagis
and appeared before him just at the time of the meal.
188. Seeing the Vaishnavas, he was overjoyed,
and receiving them all, he showed them great honour.
189. They said: "We are very hungry;
give us food, Mahashaya, and then we shall be pleased."
190. "Most kindly you have come and given me darshan;
the prasada is ready — sit down and eat."
191. "You have cooked very little, and we are many;
our hunger will not be satisfied — that is plain to see."
192. "Your hunger will be satisfied — such is the nature of prasada."
And the ten Vaishnavas sat down in a circle.
193. In this way he served them all,
filling plate after plate with great joy.
194. Half a ser of rice, made into prasada,
was partaken of by eleven Vaishnavas, and they were content.
195. Ishvari heard of this through Ishana
and understood in her heart that he had been born as prema in form.
196. "How delightful it is to hear of such a boy's virtues!
I must certainly see the boy's face."²⁶
197. At night, going with a maid to bathe in the Ganga,
she saw the boy, full of the sweetness of prema.
198. Having bathed, while it was still night, she went back to the inner apartments;
having seen the boy, she was glad at heart.²⁷
199. "How can I bring him here and question him?
How can I ask, looking at the face of a strange man?"
200. If he is the Lord's power, my shyness will go far away;
then I shall know that abundant mercy rests on him."
201. Ishvari bade Ishana bring the boy:
"Why does he weep day and night?"
202. Ishana came and said: "Listen, Srinivasa:
Ishvari is calling you — come to the Lord's house."
203. Raising his arms, Srinivasa began a long dance:
it seemed that the Pandita Gosani's state had come upon him.
204. Weeping, he went along behind Ishana;
on entering the inner chamber he grew shy.
205. Trembling, he went into the inner apartments,
but did not come close and stayed at some distance.
206. Ishana said: "Here is Srinivasa;
he bows down to you; he is your dear servant."

207. Drawing aside the inner curtain, she looked at him
and understood the reason: it is my Lord's power.
208. Setting her shyness aside, she called him herself:
"Why do you weep and wander about alone?"
209. He told her the Pandita Gosani's words:
"By his kindness I would have gone to Vrindavana.
210. What I heard from his lips in Nilachala...
Not having studied the Bhagavata, my birth has been in vain.
211. I heard the Lord's command to go to Vrindavana,
but it has not been fulfilled," he said at her feet.
212. "Now I weep without ceasing for Gadadhara;
therefore the Lord's power rests with you."
213. "I see you are still very young and tender.
Have you taken up renunciation? Go home, brahmana boy.
214. Renunciation is hard — it needs very great strength."²⁸
With joined palms he pleaded long:
215. "Let me stay near your feet;
my soul will be soothed, and I shall escape from danger.
216. I have no one in the world; only my mother is living;
how can I go to Vrindavana and still keep my life?"
217. "Without Chaitanya's power there is no such mercy."²⁹
When you are mature, then you will go; it is not fitting now.
218. Having received this command, live outside the house,
eat prasada, and let your mind grow steady."³⁰
219. Vishnupriya, in separation from Gauranga, was sorely afflicted:
her grief doubled, and she lost herself.
220. Ishvari called Ishana and said: "Listen, Ishana:
the night has gone by, and it is dawn."
221. Ishana said: "He spends the night weeping;
crying 'O Pandita Gosani!', he stays awake."
222. That day they did not meet again;
in longing for darshan, night and day went by.
223. Hear, brothers, how Ishvari took the Name —
hearing it, one comes to realise the pastimes.
224. She brings new clay pots and sets them on either side:
one pot empty, the other full of rice.
225. Each time she chants the sixteen names of thirty-two syllables,³¹
she places one grain in the pot, with joy in her heart.
226. Until the third watch she chants Hari-nama,
and whatever grains have been gathered she takes and goes to cook.
227. Cooking only those grains,
she feeds them to the Lord with tears.

228. Day and night, Hari-nama, so many rounds for the Lord!
I cannot fathom that endeavour — my mind is utterly helpless.
229. What can be said of her who is the Lord's beloved?
Day and night she ever chants Hari-nama.
230. What is impossible for her, with such longing for the Name?
She chants the Name, and in it she plants the Lord's power.
231. By the mere shadow of the Name all sins are destroyed,
the heart's desire grows, and prema is made manifest.
232. The Name is a wish-fulfilling tree — this is certain;
whoever chants the Name by count attains every perfection.
233. "The Name is the truth in the Kali age" — so it is said three times;³²
Gauranga accepts those who are free from attachment.
234. It is the best of all means of sadhana;
only by the fortune of many births does love for it arise.
235. Thus, when the third watch of the night had passed,
crying "O Chaitanya!", she lay down on the ground.
236. At the end of the night the two brothers together, in sankirtana,
dancing, say: "Where is my mother?"
237. Your daughter-in-law keeps my Srinivasa outside the gate,
while she herself is at ease in her own house!
238. All my work is to be done through Srinivasa;
send him to Abhirama, with Ishana as his companion."³³
239. In separation from Chaitanya she does not sleep at night;
having heard the nectar words of the dream, she fell silent.
240. "Ishana! Ishana!" the maids call out,
but Ishana is fast asleep and does not stir.
241. After a long while Ishana awoke,
and in fear counted himself most unfortunate.
242. With joined palms he came to Ishvari,
and she commanded: "Bring Srinivasa to me."
243. Srinivasa was weeping on a mat of kusha grass.
"Get up, get up, lad, come quickly!"³⁴
244. Standing in the courtyard, he bowed down many times,
and Ishana was told: "Take him to see Abhirama."³⁵
245. So saying, with her toes wrapped in cloth,
she called Srinivasa and raised her foot onto his head.
246. At the touch of her foot he was overcome with prema
and, rolling on the ground, began to weep.
247. "Listen, listen, my son, you are fortunate:
Chaitanya's power is in you — it cannot be otherwise.
248. Go to Shantipur, and then you will go to Khardaha;
on seeing Acharya Gosani, you will be recognised.

249. Going to Khardaha, you will see Nityananda;
finding you, Jahnava will rejoice.
250. Do not delay long; go quickly —
you will hear much and see the sweetness of beauty.
251. Having met everyone, go to Vrindavana;
all will be fulfilled — keep this in mind on the way."
252. Prostrating himself, he went to Shantipur,
and fell into great perplexity: "Where shall I stay?
253. Ishvari bade me see Advaita —
how is that command to be understood?
254. It is now the third year since Gosani passed away;
yet this command cannot be disobeyed" — doubt cast him into a quandary.
255. At that moment one appeared with arms reaching to his knees and a huge body;
seeing his radiance, Srinivasa trembled and lost all composure.
256. Unable to open his eyes, he fell to the ground.
"Come, come, Srinivasa, I have heard your words."
257. So Advaita Gosani had willed it;
prostrating himself there, Srinivasa addressed him.
258. Sighing, Gosani wept a long while:
"Where have Chaitanya and Nityananda gone in their bodies?
259. Where have their companions gone — Svarupa, Ramananda Raya?" —
and lovingly he laid his hand on Srinivasa's head.
260. "Come, come, Srinivasa, let my life be soothed;
let me embrace you and let my heart be comforted.
261. For your sake the Lord sent Gopala Bhatta;
you will become his servant — I tell you for certain.
262. Being angry with me, the Lord caused you to be born,³⁶
and here he has revealed all his own work.
263. He sent Rupa and Sanatana to Vrindavana,
and to make that known he caused you to be born.
264. For your sake he sent Gopala Bhatta;
take instruction there, in order to make prema manifest.
265. Calling 'Come, come!', with the Lord's power infused in you,
you³⁷ will flood the world, spreading prema.
266. For your sake I have appeared here;
never speak of it anywhere else.
267. Going to Khardaha, you will find joy;
having seen Jahnava, you will go to Vrindavana.
268. There you will see Sri Rupa;
go and worship the feet of Gopala Bhatta.
269. By Chaitanya's mercy you will flood the land with prema;
cry 'Advaita! Govinda!' and do not dwell on sorrow.

270. Your Lord, the best of lovers,
has by prema destroyed the corruption among my followers.³⁸
271. Whoever among my followers takes up this doctrine on his lips
will, cut off from Chaitanya and Nityananda, meet with great sorrow."
272. So saying, Advaita-chandra vanished,
and Srinivasa, parted from the vision, fell senseless.
273. At this time Mother Sita was going to bathe in the Ganga,
and she sees a jewel of a boy weeping.
274. "Child, child!" she took the boy on her lap
and comforted him with the sweetest words.
275. She asked: "Who are you? Why are you weeping?
It seems you have had the darshan of my lord.
276. Tell me, boy, where is your home?
Why have you come here, weeping so bitterly?"
277. "My name is Srinivasa; I was born at Chakhandi;
by Ishvari-ji's command I have come to see you."
278. Hearing the name Srinivasa, she rejoiced at heart:
she already knew of him from Achyutananda's letter.
279. "I have greatly wished to see you, my son;
by Chaitanya's great mercy we have met on the road."
280. Gopala Gosani³⁹ was coming from his bath;
seeing him, Srinivasa fell prostrate.
281. "Until I come back from bathing in the Ganga,
look after him carefully."
282. Leaving them together, Mother Sita went to bathe in the Ganga,
and meanwhile Gosani sat with him on one seat.
283. Having bathed, she soon came back
and saw Srinivasa and Gopala together.
284. So she took him into the inner apartments,
glad at heart to have found a wondrous Vaishnava.
285. She gave him the remnants of Advaita's meal to eat:
"I am going to cook; you sit by the door."
286. Having cooked, she offered the bhoga,
gave Krishna water to rinse his mouth and laid him down to rest.
287. Gopala was told to take prasada:
"Sit down quickly together with Srinivasa.
288. I will serve the wondrous Vaishnava myself;
sit with him, my son — it will make me very happy."
289. They sat down together to eat;
at the touch of the prasada from the Lord's lips their hair stood on end again and again.
290. Food cooked by Sita's hand, the remnants of Krishna's lips —
and the transformations of prema in all their variety.

291. Having rinsed their mouths, both in great delight
freshened their mouths and sat together in one place.⁴⁰
292. The day ended, and evening came;
seeing Krishna's joy, their joy knew no bounds.
293. That night he spent joyfully in Shantipur,⁴¹
and in the morning went to Sita to take his leave.
294. "I have one request — listen carefully:
on coming to this village I heard the words 'Advaita, Govinda'.⁴²
295. Tell me, Mother, the true account of this,
and then give me leave to go and see Khardaha."
296. "What need have you to hear this, boy?
Attend to your own business and go on your travels."
297. "Permit me, Mother — I long to hear it;
be gracious and kindly tell me."
298. Such is a boy's nature — he holds fast to what he has said;
and Mother Sita could not refuse him.
299. "Listen with a steady mind, Srinivasa;
when you hear it, you will believe with a calm heart.
300. At the time when Jagai and Madhai were delivered,
Gosani⁴³ in anger said to Haridasa:
301. 'If Gosani does not give me the union of prema,
I will dry up all prema — and the fault will not be mine.'
302. Angry with Nityananda, he came home
and sent a riddle, a tarja, written through Jagadananda.
303. From that day anger arose in the Lord:
to Nityananda he gave companions — Ramai, Sundarananda and others,
304. and to my Thakura he gave Kamadeva Nagara,
and in his anger made the Nagara speak.⁴⁴
305. My lord came to Gauda with the Nagara in his company,
and amid the waves of prema the Nagara set a doctrine going.
306. As soon as I heard it, anger arose in me,
and I never looked on the Nagara's face again.
307. I separated my maidservant Nandini from me,⁴⁵
and I no longer listen to those words.
308. Some of my sons hold to Achyuta's view,
and some, following the Nagara, have gone astray.
309. I rejoice in the sons who hold to Achyuta's view;
and Nityananda, coming to Gauda, flooded it with prema.
310. Gosani could not restrain the Nagara,
and for that reason this circle became hostile.
311. Listen, Srinivasa, my heart is sorely pained:
having quarrelled with my sons, I keep to my house.⁴⁶

312. Whoever stands with Achyuta, the son of Chaitanya's maidservant,⁴⁷
does not speak this doctrine; whoever speaks it has no tie with me."

313. Hearing this, he rejoiced greatly at heart,
and Srinivasa prostrated himself again and again.

314. The Mother dispelled all the doubts in his mind,
and prostrating himself, he took leave of Sita.

315. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the fourth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Narahari Sarakara Thakura of Srikhanda (Khanda).
2. This line is found only in the 1913 edition.
3. The line "khaṇḍa haite gamana haila gaṅgā haite pāra" is unclear; translated by the sense.
4. That is, he died (a euphemism: the dying are carried to the Ganga). In the 1999 edition the first line of the couplet is lost.
5. Variant: "my very frail boy".
6. Variant: "with whom have you left me, Father?"
7. Apparently Srinivasa and Narottama.
8. The line "yājigrāma dekhīā dekhīa narahari" is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
9. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
10. Nayana Sena, a resident of Srikhanda.
11. That is, without having received initiation from a guru.
12. Variant: "towards the end of the night he slept and was half awake".
13. Variant: "Why do you wait for a refuge?"
14. Gadadhara Pandita, who lived in Puri at the temple of Tota-Gopinatha.
15. The Deity Tota-Gopinatha in Puri, served by Gadadhara Pandita.
16. Variant: "now he swooned, now he laughed, and his body trembled".
17. That is, made me your own.
18. Srinivasa.
19. Ishvari here is Vishnupriya, Mahaprabhu's consort, who lived in Navadvipa.
20. The line "se divasa vīracandra-bāṛite bahu saṁghaṭe" is understood thus; perhaps Virachandra was then a guest of Narahari.
21. Variant note: "Not having studied the Bhagavata, he was sunk in grief."
22. A chhatak is a small measure, about 60 g.
23. Perhaps one should read "was much grieved" (duḥkha for sukha); both copies have sukha.
24. The line "caitanya aprakaṭe virakta manera saṁśaya" is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
25. In the 1913 edition couplet 184 (second line) to 185 is in brackets.
26. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
27. Variant: "she was filled with great compassion".
28. Variant: "Hearing that renunciation is hard, he was greatly afraid."
29. Variant: "there is no such state".
30. Variant: "'As you command,' he said, and carefully went out."
31. The maha-mantra "Hare Krishna": sixteen names, thirty-two syllables.
32. An allusion to the well-known verse "harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam...", in which the word "Name" is repeated three times.
33. Chaitanya and Nityananda speak, addressing Shachi ("Mother") in the dream; "your daughter-in-law" is Vishnupriya. Abhirama (Ramadasa) was a companion of Nityananda who lived at Khanakul.
34. This couplet is complete only in the 1913 edition (the 1999 edition keeps only the second line).

35. It could also be understood as "see how lovely he is" (abhirāma, "lovely"); in view of couplet 238 we take it as the name.
36. An allusion to Advaita's "riddle" and his preaching of mukti, which troubled Mahaprabhu (see vilasa 1).
37. Literally "he"; address to Srinivasa and speech about him are mixed here.
38. The couplet is unclear ("tomāra ye prabhu ihā nāgara vara dvāre / gaṇaduṣṭa prema dvārā karila saṁhāre"); the rendering is tentative.
39. Gopala, one of the sons of Advaita Acharya and Sita.
40. In the 1913 edition couplets 282–291 are in brackets; in the 1999 edition the second line of couplet 290 is lost.
41. The 1999 edition has "that night he spent in Shantipur, at the arati".
42. Cf. couplet 269. The point of the request is to learn the truth about Advaita's "riddle" and the mukti doctrine of some of his followers.
43. Advaita Acharya.
44. Kamadeva Nagara is known as a follower of Advaita who preached a doctrine at odds with Mahaprabhu's bhakti. The line "krodha kari nāgara kahila vākya dvāre" is understood tentatively.
45. The line "svatantra karilu āmi sevaka nandinī" is unclear; Nandini was apparently a maidservant (disciple) of Sita.
46. Literally "having quarrelled with my sons, I go to sleep at home"; the sense of the line is unclear.
47. Achyutananda, son of Advaita and Sita, faithful to Mahaprabhu's teaching; "Chaitanya's maidservant" is Sita herself. In the 1999 edition the first line of the couplet is lost.